

Comprehensive Case Management Plan

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Lily and her partner, Rosemary, are both graduate students at Clemson University and currently live together in an off-campus apartment, along with their two dogs. Recently the relationship has become toxic, with Rosemary drinking and acting violently including damaging property and physically assaulting Lily. When Lily expressed her desire to leave the relationship and move out, Rosemary threatened to take their dogs, and later sent threatening texts, including a reminder that they know Lily's schedule. Lily would like to stay on track with her schooling while getting away from her abusive relationship and protecting herself, her dogs, and property. Being mid-semester makes schedule conflicts more likely. If she were to need to change her schedule for her own safety, she would need to discuss the situation with her academic advisor and professors to see if there is a solution. She also fears for her dogs' safety so would like to take them with her when she moves. While she has friends she can stay with in the short term, she still needs to get her stuff and find a more permanent living situation, as she is unsure how long she can stay with them. On-and-off-campus protection is a priority for the safety and wellbeing of Lily. Local or campus police should be informed of the situation as soon as viable. Secondly, Lily needs a safe living space away from Rosemary, and in the longer term she may need to break her lease to move. She also will likely need social support, such as individual or group therapy to help her cope with the domestic violence trauma. Dealing with abuse of any kind can make it harder to focus or do work, and as a graduate student, both of those aspects are important to staying on track. If she does end up needing to move, she will also likely need help with rent, utilities, and moving expenses, especially because moving mid-semester can be a financial burden and a heavy time sink, which are both disadvantageous.

Rationale for Case Management Model

The model primarily used for this case is the brokerage model. Resources were selected based on the client, Lily's, needs, and were distributed to her with a brief explanation of what they are and

how they can help her. The resources which were selected as part of the asset map were related to filing police reports with local and campus police, discussing her schedule with school faculty, options for therapy on-and-off campus, and options for breaking her lease and moving, if necessary. These resources were selected to act as both a main plan and a fallback plan in case one or more situations do not work out favorably. This case also involves the strengths-based approach, as Lily has a community of friends she can rely on and has managed to survive long into her relationship before needing to distance herself from it. Being a graduate student means she also has access to a broad range of faculty and staff, and has little schooling left before she will be able to permanently escape Rosemary. Lily has multiple needs and would require a variety of resources. As a social worker, acting as a broker and managing her case, the responsibility would be to find her those resources and ensure the quality of services, while working around any limitations that may arise (Woodside & McClam, 2018).

Potential Interventions

A lot of Lily's strengths lie in her community of friends and peers, and her ability to ask them for help. As a graduate student, she has access to a lot of school staff and is likely to have faculty that is willing to help her or advocate for her. As previously stated, Lily's primary needs are to have a safe, and preferably stable, place to live. She has the ability to stay with some of her friends temporarily, which may allow time for other resources to be found which can more efficiently help her. Her first step should be to file a report with the police. This will allow her to later file a restraining order or order of protection and will act as evidence in case more violence occurs in the interim. Her next step should be filing an order of protection. An order of protection can act as a restraining order which also protects individual property, including pets, and allows one to have exclusive access to an abode. This is likely the best option, as it would disallow further destruction of property and would grant Lily legal protection from Rosemary if they were to act on their threats and try to take the dogs or accost Lily again.

Assuming the order of protection is accepted, she should then talk to the property management and get the locks changed, to ensure Rosemary cannot enter the premises.

In Relation to School

After filing with local police and court officials, it would be a good idea to also talk to campus police to inform them of the situation. This would help ensure Lily's safety while away from home, and also allow them to investigate Rosemary, which may end up with academic removal. After that, she can get with her academic advisor(s) and discuss changing her class schedule and talk with her professors to see if that is something they would be able to accommodate. She can also seek therapy through the school or find local support groups for sufferers of domestic violence. This can help her feel less isolated and help her cope with the trauma she experienced.

Barriers and Fallback Plans

The only major barrier I foresee with the resources suggested is the possibility that the order of protection could be denied. The rest of the resources listed are as a backup in case this happens. It would be wise to preemptively contact them either way. The primary resources that are recommended are related to moving out of the apartment and finding somewhere else to stay. The first steps should be contacting the apartment complex and informing them of the situation, providing relevant police or court documentation if necessary. South Carolina Bill 4158 has a clause pertaining to the breaking of a lease in cases of documented domestic violence (SC 2023-2024). If needed, there are also local tenant lawyers listed as resources, who should be able to assist with any legal troubles related to getting out of the apartment. The final resources which Lily may need are related to rental and housing assistance, as well as pet boarding. These are listed to help her, financially, and ensure her dogs' safety away from Rosemary in case her potential future home does not allow pets.

Workable Goals

Lily's goals should be focused on her personal safety and ability to continue with her schooling. Her first goal should be to have a safe living space away from Rosemary, whether it is her current residence or a new home. Her first steps for this should be to stay with friends or anywhere else she can, away from the apartment, while she files a police report. Secondly, filing a restraining order or equivalent protection document with the local courts can help her have more legal protections in case Rosemary attempts anything. Finally, getting the locks changed to physically halt Rosemary will ensure better security for Lily and her belongings.

If the legal route is not one which Lily wishes to take, her goal should be to get her stuff and find a permanent residence as quickly as possible. Her first step with this is to get her lease broken by talking to the property management, and legal consultants if needed. Next, she can seek help from local non-profits or domestic violence shelters to get assistance with her living situation or expenses. If needed, she can find a pet shelter or boarding place so that her dogs are also safely away from Rosemary.

Lily's other primary focus should be on ensuring her schooling stays on track for her graduation. She should report to the campus police to make sure that they are aware of the situation and can act to ensure her on-campus safety. Next, she should speak with her academic advisor and professors to request assistance with changing her class schedule. She may also talk with education services, as they might be able to find alternative solutions for her.

Monitoring Progress

The best way to monitor progress with Lily is to meet with her after each step or objective has been completed. This will be the most accurate way to ensure that the care she needs is being received. It's best to offer assistance as she needs it, and track completion of her goals, to ensure both her safety and stability. The goals being straightforward, with simple and small steps, makes evaluating their effectiveness simple as well. The goals are complete when Lily is safely in a home, away from Rosemary,

whether she has to move or not, and when she is safe on campus, whether be it because of Rosemary's removal, or because of a schedule change. The abundance of choices that Lily has available to her ensures that there is no shortage of options which can lead to a positive outcome.

Limitations

There are very few limitations or ethical considerations pertaining to Lily's case. Primarily, there is the potential for her to not want to file a report with the police, for whatever reason she may have. Many victims of domestic violence don't file police reports, and given that Rosemary has made threats against Lily, it's possible that she may be too scared of retaliation. It's also possible that due to the length of the relationship, she would be unwilling to file. As a mandated reporter, the incident would still need to be reported, which may seem like a violation of trust. There are also alternative options for filing an order of protection. While a police report may be unavoidable, the rest of the legal options that were listed as resources aren't. Lily has the option to break her lease and move, if that is preferable to her. Beyond that is the consideration of applicability for assistance, assuming the legal route is not viable or favorable. While domestic abuse is often a case for needing assistance, it may not be for some groups, so time could be wasted on searching that could have otherwise gone to getting her safely moved. The more choices there are, the more likely she'll be approved for assistance, so requesting or applying to each one would be key for ensuring fast and efficient care. Confidentiality is also something that would likely need to be maintained, as Rosemary poses a potential risk to Lily no matter where she is. Whatever schedule changes and living situation changes are made, they would need to be secure to keep the information from somehow getting back to Rosemary. Police on-and-off campus being informed should lax this need significantly, as anything Rosemary does can have swift recourse. However until such time as safety is certain, most of the information pertaining to the case should be kept to those directly involved in the case.

Critical Reflection

With any case it is good to know its strengths and limitations, so as to better work around any shortcomings which may arise. While this plan does have some shortcomings, with some options being potentially less viable than others, the overall case is very manageable. The very fact that there are multiple options to choose from, that can act as a backup plan in case another plan is undesired or fails to be effective, is one of this plan's major strengths. Overall, Lily's safety is a priority, with keeping track of school being a secondary goal. With the proposed plan, both should not only be possible, but viable so long as a proper timeline is maintained, and guidelines are followed. The challenges this case have are relatively minor, given the area and options available. Lily has the potential to leave or stay in her home, and different avenues for dealing with her schedule. No plan is perfect, including this one, but it sets out to accomplish an important goal, while including fail-safe options to ensure Lily's safety is always considered.

References

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